

ADOPTING OPEN EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES



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Adopting Open Educational Resources

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This text was compiled on 04/14/2026

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Detailed Licensing

Detailed Licensing

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

Introduction

Welcome

Welcome to the first section, Adopting Open Educational Resources (OER), of a three part OPEN FL OER certification program. The following modules are designed to introduce instructors to adopting Open Educational Resources (OER) into courses. Adapting and Authoring OER will be covered in later sections.

Abbreviations

CC: Creative Commons

OER: Open Educational Resources

OPEN FL: The open and affordable learning community of the state of Florida

ZTC: Zero Textbook Costs

Note

Thank you to Hillsborough Community College, Josh Hill, and Kristin Heathcock, for providing a Pressbooks home for these modules and for tech support.

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Understanding Open Educational Resources

[1.1: Introduction to Open Educational Resources](#)

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1.1: Introduction to Open Educational Resources



[“An Introduction to Open Educational Resources”](#)

By: Abbey Elder. Licensed under [CC BY 4.0](#). [Transcript](#)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to:

- Define Open Educational Resources
- Identify Reasons to Use Open Educational Resources

Introduction

Open Educational Resources (OER) provide students and instructors free access to a variety of high quality content. These collective resources have been developed, reviewed, and shared across the world. Instructors can easily adopt OER to use within their courses. Access cost and use of OER are much lower than current rising costs of textbooks and resources.

OPEN = FREE + PERMISSION(S)

Learning Objective Check-In

OER is an affordable alternative to the current rising costs of textbooks and other classroom resources.

☐ True

☐ False

☒ Check

Defining Open Educational Resources

Scholarly Publishing and Academic Resources Coalition (SPARC) defines OER as

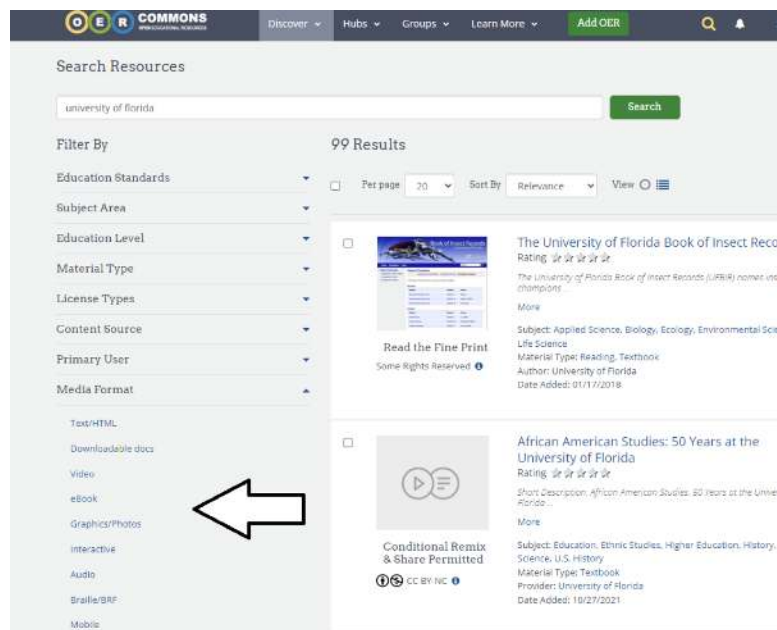
*“teaching, learning, and research resources that are **free of cost and access barriers**, and which also carry **legal permission** for open use.”*

Generally, these permissions are granted by an open license. (Most commercial textbooks do not have open licenses: they are “all rights reserved” with no permissions allowed). Open licenses grant permissions for anyone to use and retain the content under set terms and conditions. Free to access and available in many subjects, OER often extend beyond mere textbooks. OER encompass a wide array of educational materials, including:

- full courses
- course modules
- textbooks
- syllabi
- lectures
- videos
- images
- homework assignments
- quiz questions
- lab activities
- games
- simulations
- and more!

The right to retain allows individuals to keep the content for as long as they wish. “Reuse rights” means anyone can share with others (for example, students). Some OER grant additional permissions, which will be covered later. Most OER are available via the internet. Some OER have print versions for purchase. Most can be printed by individual users.

It is important to note that OER come in a variety of file formats. This screenshot from OER Commons shows the rich selection of file types available for an institution’s listings:



Florida's Definition of Open Educational Resources

Drag the words into the correct boxes

“open educational resources” means teaching,
learning, and research resources that reside in the
or have been released under an intellectual property
 that permits the and
repurposing of such resources by others.

high-quality

free use

license

public domain

Reasons to Use Open Educational Resources

Instructors benefit from using OER, especially those who want content that meets their individual preferences. Many OER now include ancillary materials and instructor-focused content. Also, instructors can decide when and how to update material: publishers no longer control release of new editions. In addition, OER integrates well with open pedagogy, whereby instructors create a more dynamic, student-centered educational environment, increasing classroom engagement. Instructors who embrace OER are gaining recognition from their institutions and peers; incorporating OER aligns well with the teaching, research, and service criteria for promotion and tenure

The following benefits have been found with OER (Ainsworth, 2020):

- Ability to use, share, edit, and adapt
- Ability to produce the resource in alternate formats
- Ownership of the content forever
- Flexibility in when and whether to move to a new edition
- Access to course content in formats for various devices and situations
- Option to download the text for when internet access is not available
- Instant, unlimited, and permanent access to content
- Eliminate need to buy content multiple times or for longer periods
- Enable use of the content as a reference
- Ease study for entrance and certification exams
- Provide content for lifelong learning and career changes
- Ability to print course material
- Broader student access to course materials
- Increased retention and degree progression (Fischer et al., 2015)
- Lower fail and withdraw rates (Colvard, Watson, and Park, 2018)
- Enhanced pedagogy
- Positive public relations; Increased impact and visibility
- Showcase efforts to reduce student costs

In states across the nation textbook affordability and student success are of utmost importance. OER supports this critical mission. In the [infographic](#) below Open Education Global addresses these benefits:

REASONS TO USE OPEN EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES



1 IMPROVE STUDENT LEARNING



Having the ability to retain, reuse, revise, remix, and redistribute, **OER** leads to a more personal learning experience for the student. Increased motivation, creativity and critical thinking skills through the use of **OER** are leading to improved academic results.

2 INCREASE ACCESS TO TEACHING AND LEARNING RESOURCES

OER provides students and teachers with a wider variety of resources allowing a more customized learning experience. **OER** gives faculty the ability to customize course materials, creating the "perfect" course packet or textbook instead of being bound to a traditional one-size-fits-all model.



Customization gives faculty control over the quality of their course materials as well as the type and timing of updates to textbooks and other resources.

3 EXPAND ACCESS TO LEARNING



OER directly impacts the availability and accessibility of education. According to the Cape Town Open Education Declaration, **OER** is more than just the right thing to do; they constitute a wise investment in teaching and learning for the 21st century. They will make it possible to redirect funds from expensive textbooks towards better learning. They will help teachers excel in their work and provide new opportunities for visibility and global impact.



OPEN EDUCATION
CONSORTIUM

The Global Network for Open Education

www.oecconsortium.org

Figure 1.1.1: Copy and Paste Caption here. (Copyright; author via source)

Instructor Voice

“Using OER in my class has been a game-changer. Not only do my students have access to high quality resources, regardless of financial constraints, but I have the flexibility to tailor materials to meet the needs of all my students and align with specific learning objectives. OER is not just about teaching; it’s about enriching the educational landscape and empowering students to succeed.”

*Erik Christensen, Physics and Astronomy Professor
South Florida State College*

Conclusion

Knowing what OER is and why to use it in the class is the start of the path to adopting OER. The next chapter will dive deeper into defining open content to sharpen an understanding of material available to adopt.

Chapter Assessment

Which of the following describes OER?

- ☐ Sourced from a commercial publisher
- ☐ Free on the internet
- ☐ Available in high resolution formats
- ☐ Free of cost with no access barriers and having legal permission for open use

✓ Check

 Reuse  Rights of use  Embed

H-P



Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 1 Intro

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning objectives:

--Define Open Educational Resources (OER)

--Identify reasons to use OER

☐ Yes

☐ No

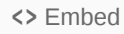
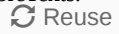
Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chapter's learning objectives:

--Define Open Educational Resources (OER)

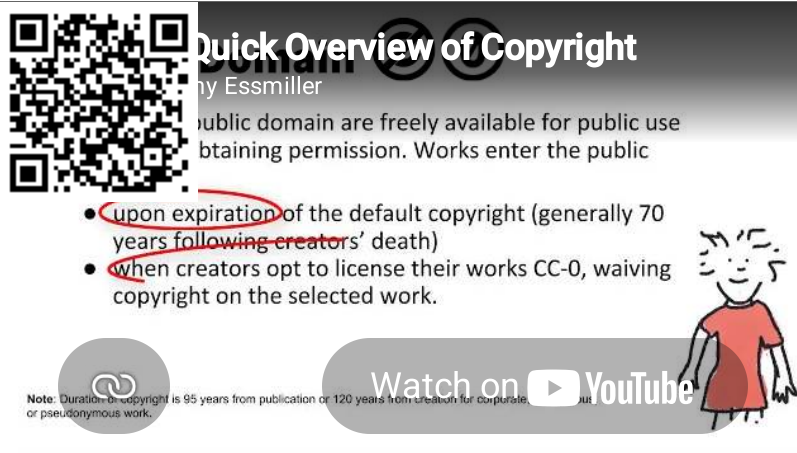
--Identify reasons to use OER

Submit

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1.2: Understanding Open Educational Resources



Quick Overview of Copyright
by Kathy Essmiller

Public domain materials are freely available for public use without obtaining permission. Works enter the public domain:

- upon expiration of the default copyright (generally 70 years following creators' death)
- when creators opt to license their works CC-0, waiving copyright on the selected work.

Note: Duration of copyright is 95 years from publication or 120 years from creation for corporate or pseudonymous work.

Watch on YouTube

[“A Quick Overview of Copyright”](#)

By Kathy Essmiller. Licensed under [CC-BY](#). [Transcripts](#).

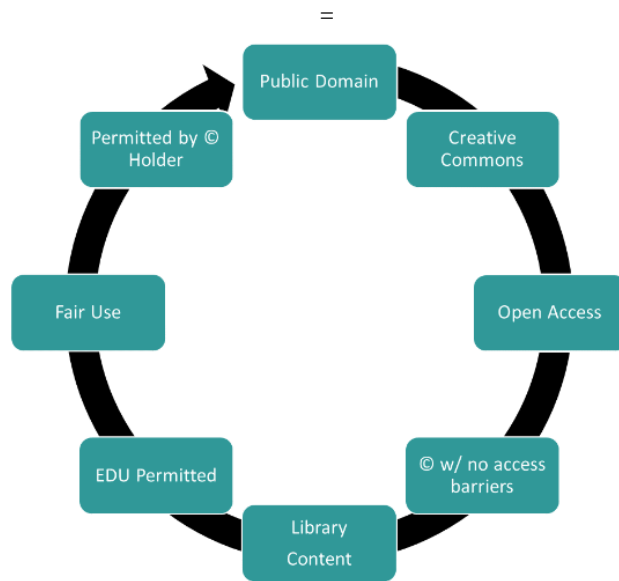
Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to :

- Recognize Open Educational Resources (OER) in a Spectrum of Open
- Define what Zero Textbook Cost (ZTC) means

Introduction

Usage rights set Open Educational Resources (OER) apart from traditional materials. Authors of OER can set a variety of different levels of “openness” rights. The Spectrum of Open can help visualize these different levels. It can guide the search for the optimum OER. The first category at the top of the “O” is the public domain. Public Domain materials are the most open content that can be used in an educational setting. Instructors should start their journey to find suitable, quality content there.



The Spectrum of Open

. By
[OPEN FL](#)
 & Rebel Cummings-
 Sauls

Learning Objective Check-In

The Spectrum of Open is a tool to help course creators understand the range of free content for students available for inclusion as class learning material, true or false?

☐ True

☐ False

☒ Check

The Spectrum of Open

The [OPEN-FL](#) Community's Spectrum of Open infographic (shown above) supports an equitable, affordable learning experience. By learning how to incorporate these resources responsibly and effectively, instructors will be ready to reduce cost barriers for students. To compare the types of open content by characteristics, use The Spectrum of Open Table below as a quick reference guide:

Type	Openly Licensed	Freely Available	Modifiable
Public Domain	No	Yes	Yes
Creative Commons	Yes	Yes	Maybe— see specific CC license
Open Access	Yes	Yes	Maybe— see license, terms, permissions, or agreements
Indicates Open; Copyrighted with Use Terms and No Access Barriers	Maybe— see license, terms, permissions, or agreements	Yes	Likely no— see license, terms, permissions, agreements
Library Content	Maybe— see license, terms, permissions, or agreements	For Instructors and Students	Likely no— see license, terms, permissions, agreements
Education Use Permitted	No	Select Content w/ Public or Student Access	Likely no— see license, terms, permissions, agreements
Fair Use	No	Select Content w/ Public or Student Access	Likely no— Depends on Fair Use Argument
Permitted by Copyright Holder	Seek permission by copyright holder	Seek permission by copyright holder	Seek permission by copyright holder

Focus on Open in Florida

In Florida, [Statute Section 1004.085](#) (6)(c) states that:

“the State Board of Education and the Board of Governors shall adopt affordability policies, procedures, and guidelines which the state’s higher education institutions can implement to “minimize the cost of textbooks and instructional materials for students.”

These policies, procedures, and guidelines shall address *“the extent to which an open-access book or instructional material is available.”* Additionally, there is further support to lower or eliminate the cost of instructional materials through continued and growing legislation. A key piece of this movement is OER as defined by the state statutes ([Section 1006.73\(4\)\(a\)](#)). This includes support for the Student Open Access Resources (SOAR) repository (discussed later in Searching for OER) and the Zero Textbook Cost (ZTC) indicator, shown below.

Zero Textbook Cost

ZTC

The materials listed in the table above, used individually or in combination, are all ways to achieve complete cost savings for students. By using open and zero cost materials, a course can be designated as a ZTC course. This indicates to students that there are no costs for access and use of required course materials. [FloridaShines](#), the statewide online course search hub, employs a ZTC course marking and filter.

For further information about ZTC courses in Florida, please visit this [FAQ](#) page.

Florida's Zero Textbook Cost Definition

Drag the words into the correct boxes

Zero Textbook Cost Qualifications:

~ [] associated with the section must be [] for student access, including ancillaries, homework, quizzes, etc.

~May include [], [], institution developed content, institutionally retained or [] that [] enrolled in the course have [] to use, public domain, Creative Commons licensed, or any other properly licensed and adopted materials.

zero cost

faculty developed content

NOT qualify

simultaneous access

all students

open educational resources

licensed campus library materials

Required course materials

Instructor Voice

“Adopting Open Educational Resources isn’t just about access; it’s about empowering learners with the freedom to explore, the tools to excel, and the knowledge to shape a brighter future without boundaries.”

*Douglas Kines, Professor of Biological Sciences
Florida State College at Jacksonville*

Conclusion

Understanding the spectrum of open content available is an important piece of the journey towards adopting OER for a class. Familiarity with the terms OER and ZTC help instructors make informed course content choices. Instructors are highly encouraged to adopt OER textbooks and ancillary items for classes. The next chapter will show how to identify OER so instructors feel comfortable adopting it.

Chapter Assessment

ZTC means that there are no textbook costs required with the course, true or false?

☐ True☐ False☒ Check



Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 2 Under

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning objectives:

--Recognize Open Educational Resources (OER) in a Spectrum of Open

--Define what Zero Textbook Cost (ZTC) means

☐ Yes

☐ No

Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chapter:

--Understand Open Educational Resources (OER) in a Spectrum of Open

--Define what Zero Textbook Cost (ZTC) means

Submit

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Selecting Open Educational Resources

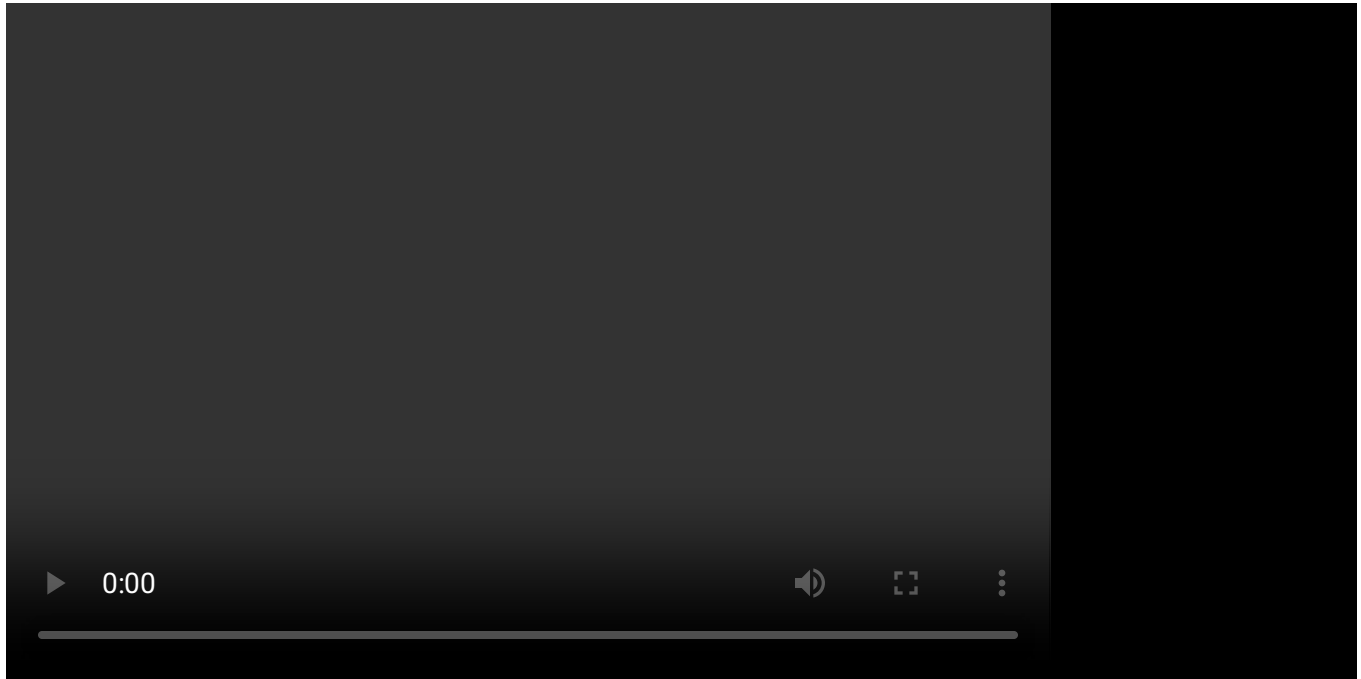
[2.1: Identifying Open Educational Resources](#)

[2.2: Searching for Open Educational Resources](#)

[2.3: Evaluating Open Educational Resources](#)

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2.1: Identifying Open Educational Resources



The Spectrum of Open Introduction. Rebel Cummings-Sauls. 2024. [Transcript](#).

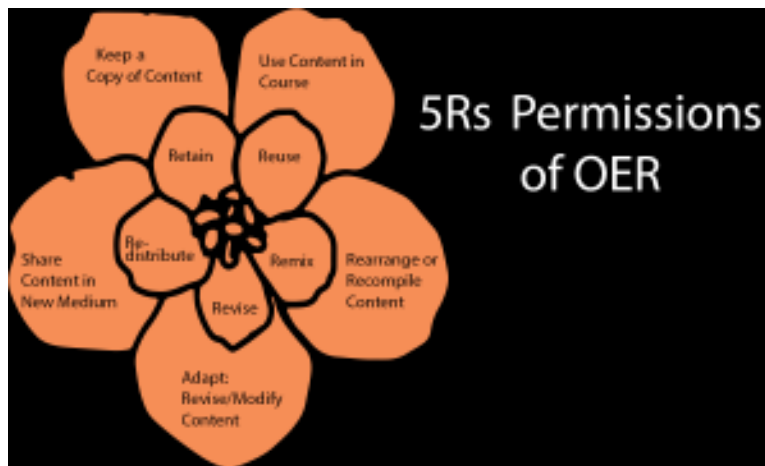
Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to:

- Understand How to Identify Open Educational Resources in the Public Domain
- Identify Open Educational Resources by Recognizing Creative Commons Licenses
- Understand How Open Access Content with Permissions can Function as Open Educational Resources

Introduction

Adopting an open educational resources (OER) is usually straightforward. Only a basic knowledge of OER terms is needed to start. The first step to adopting an OER is to know how to find one. Instructors and other material selectors need to be able to identify OER in the real world. Content on web sites and in print can both be OER. The Spectrum of Open displays the most open content in the top right quarter of the circle. The most common OER also “live” here. If instructors get stuck trying to find potential OER to adopt, they should seek help. Library and copyright experts are excellent resources to learn more on OER and copyright. Learning to recognize public domain, Creative Commons (CC) licensed, and open access content with permissions is a skill that builds with time. “Retain” and “Reuse” rights are the most important permissions needed when looking to adopt OER.



The 5Rs of OER began with David Wiley (illustrated here as “5Rs Permissions of OER” by Rebel Cummings-Sauls, 2024) and shows the gamut of permissions that one may find with OER and within the Spectrum of Open.

Learning Objective Check-In

Learning to spot a Creative Commons license or a public domain mark/statement is an important step in identifying potential OER to adopt, true or false?

☐ True

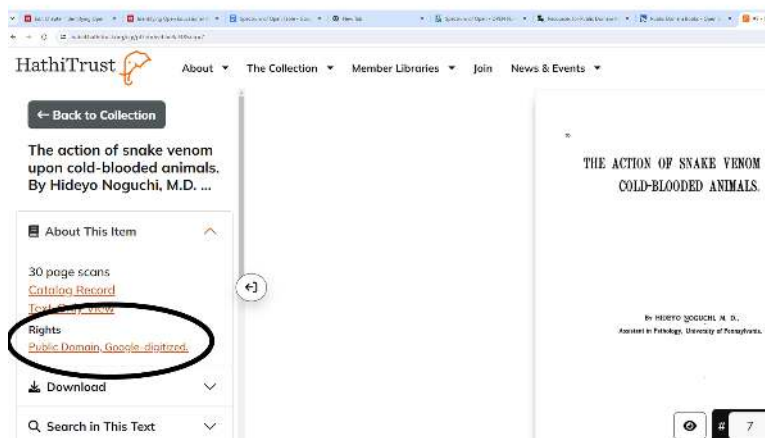
☐ False

☒ Check

Public Domain

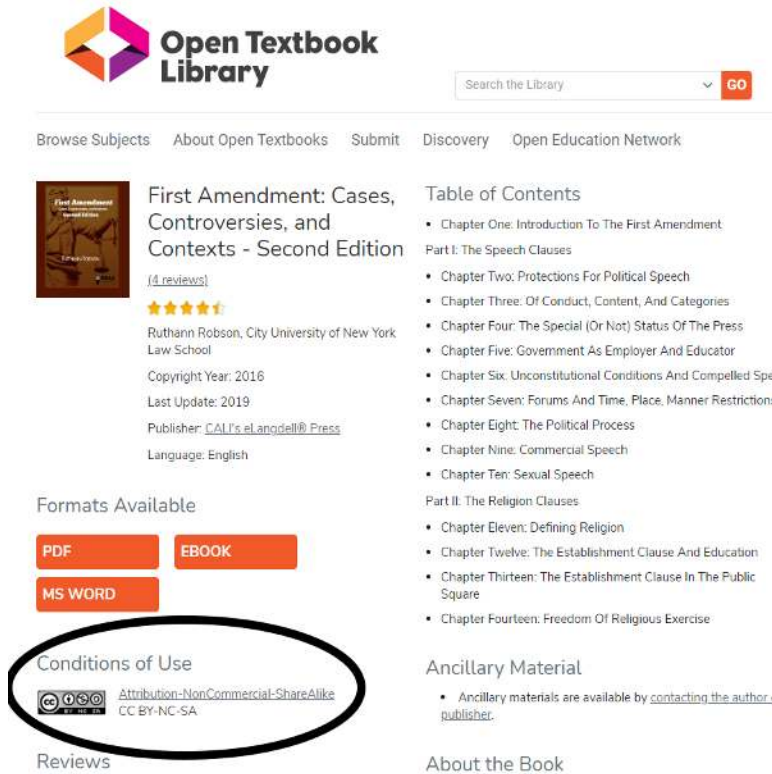


The most open content, that is the public domain, may have a marker (shown here) or a statement of status (shown below). As these are newer designations, material will most likely have no indication that it is in the public domain. In this case, tools like the [Copyright Genie](#) (link opens in new tab) may help check the public domain status.



Creative Commons

Openly licensed material available under [Creative Commons](#) (CC) licenses are easy to identify, see example below.



Open Textbook Library

Search the Library

[Browse Subjects](#) [About Open Textbooks](#) [Submit](#) [Discovery](#) [Open Education Network](#)

First Amendment: Cases, Controversies, and Contexts - Second Edition
 (4 reviews)
 ★★★★★
 Ruthann Robson, City University of New York Law School
 Copyright Year: 2016
 Last Update: 2019
 Publisher: [CAL's eLangdell Press](#)
 Language: English

Formats Available

Conditions of Use
 [Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike](#)
 CC BY-NC-SA

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 - Chapter Thirteen: The Establishment Clause In The Public Square
 - Chapter Fourteen: Freedom Of Religious Exercise

Ancillary Material

- Ancillary materials are available by [contacting the author or publisher](#).

Reviews **About the Book**

There are six licenses ranging from most free to least free, and the CC license should be visible with content. The license may be found on a digital resource's landing page, back of the title page in a print book, or an easy-to-find spot in the resource. Each license may have one or more of these four elements:

- BY-Attribution
- SA-Share Alike
- NC-Non-Commercial
- ND-No Derivatives

All CC licenses require attribution. The following graphic shows the six CC licenses:

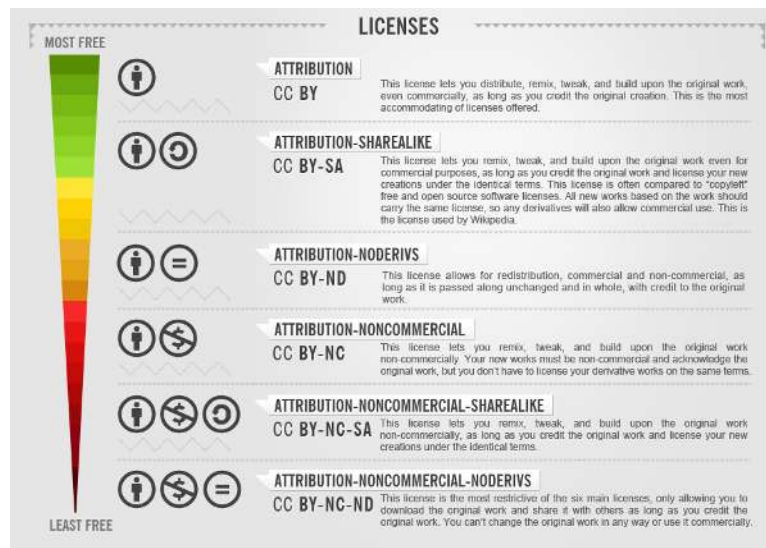


Figure 2.1.1: Copy and Paste Caption here. (Copyright; author via source)

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Creative Commons Icons Match Text with Icon

No
Remixes
or
Revisions

Give
Attribution

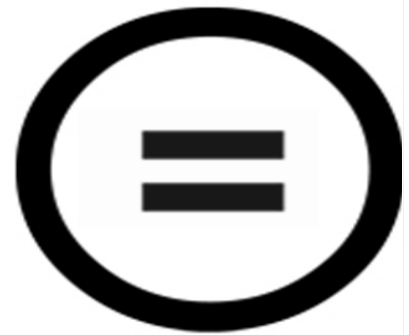
Share w/
Same
License



BY



NC



ND

✓ Check

 Reuse  Rights of use  Embed

H-P

Open Access

Open Access has traditionally meant “free + permissions.” Often open access resources (like the [Directory of Open Access Books](#), opens in a new tab) will have CC licenses. Some open access content may have another open license (not from CC) or publisher’s terms of agreement. Like CC licenses, these permissions can provide use rights or direction on what kind of reuse is authorized. All licenses and terms of agreement should be read thoroughly to understand what is permitted. Free to access with proper use permissions, open access resources can be a no-cost, high quality option for course content.



Figure 2.1.1: Copy and Paste Caption here. (Copyright; author via source)

Instructor Voice

“Adopting open educational resources may seem daunting at first, but they allow educators, like me, to tailor content to meet my students’ unique needs while breaking down cost barriers. I can attest that since adopting OERs, I have higher levels of engagement and participation from my students. It truly is remarkable what free access to course materials can do for our students’ education.”

Amanda Groff, Anthropology Professor, University of Central Florida

Conclusion

Identifying OER is an important skill to learn in order to find material for a class. If instructors need help with identifying public domain, CC licenses, open licenses, or publisher terms and for all remaining points on the Spectrum of Open, we encourage them to work with a local librarian or copyright expert. Please note that content found with no CC/open license or permissions and it is not in the public domain must be considered as “all rights reserved” under U.S. copyright. The next chapter will address the next step in selecting an OER: building search strategies.

Assessment

The Creative Commons license with the most freedom is CC-BY-SA, true or false?

☐ True

☐ False

☒ Check





Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 3 Identifier

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning objectives:

- Understand how to identify Open Educational Resources in the public domain
- Identify Open Educational Resources by recognizing Creative Commons licenses
- Understand how open access content with permissions can function as Open Educational Resources

☐ Yes

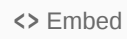
☐ No

Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chapter:

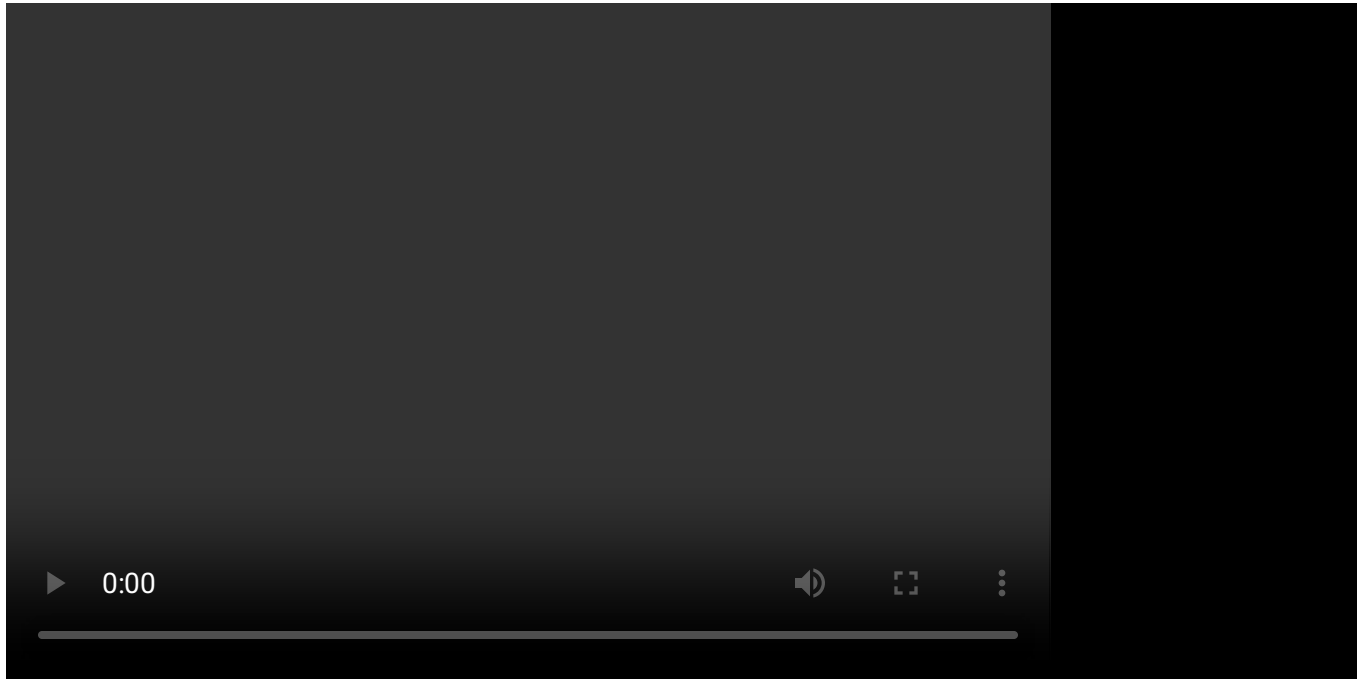
- Understand how to identify Open Educational Resources in the public domain
- Identify Open Educational Resources by recognizing Creative Commons licenses
- Understand how open access content with permissions can function as Open Educational Resources

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2.2: Searching for Open Educational Resources



“How to Find and Evaluate OER” By Abbey Elder. Licensed under  [Transcript](#).

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to:

- Understand and Apply Effective Search Strategies when Looking for Open Educational Resources
- Identify Several Online Open Educational Resources Repositories

Introduction

After learning how to identify an OER in the last chapter, this chapter will cover searching for the right OER material. The video above overviews a three-step search process for finding OER, just like students use when researching a topic for a paper:

An instructor’s search for OER is much the same.

Learning Objective Check-In

When evaluating an OER resource, it is important that you check that the content matches your course learning objectives, true or false?

☐ True

☐ False

 Check

 Reuse

 Rights of use

 Embed

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Identify

Identifying a topic involves outlining keywords and planning a search strategy. Instructors may pull together a keyword outline by identifying the main and sub-topics for OER content with the following:

These will provide important topics and keywords in the search for content to adopt. Search strategies might involve combining terms in different ways, adding term(s) to broaden a search, or subtracting terms to narrow search results. Titles, headings, keywords, and context of OER should closely match what is stated within the SLOs. Likewise, instructors should select OER content (either whole or in part) that meet course objectives. Degree pathway indicators for the course or program are also important to consider when searching for OER. For instance, if “licensure exam pass rate” is an indicator, that concept should figure into a search strategy (for example, content to improve/aid licensure exams). With this information, instructors should be able to pull together a search strategy which will yield OER content to compile. Instructors may want to include additional factors to identify, like if ancillary materials (for example, quizzes/tests) are available with the OER.



[Identify Customer](#) by [Pixel True](#) CC BY 4.0

Compile

Instructors are encouraged to pull together the resource(s) that work best for them. When looking to adopt OER in place of a current commercial resource, start the search in an open textbook repository. Find sites that offer full course packs, textbooks, class presentation slides, quizzes, homework assignments, and exams. Course packs should be highly considered, as they may offer an easy path to adopt OER. Compiling a list of potential OER to adopt may seem overwhelming, as there are literally millions of openly licensed resources available. It is important that instructors feel confident when trying to find relevant resources. So, begin searching with targeted OER sites. The video in this section provided a good overview of two common repositories for finding OER:

Please take a few moments to review other options below. Take note of the site(s) that may best fit the course needs.

- [MERLOT](#)
- [OpenStax](#)
- [Pressbooks](#)
- [LibreTexts](#)

Student Open Access Resources



The OPEN FL community have been pulling resources together in the [Student Open Access Resources \(SOAR\) Repository](#). Collections include courses with high dual enrollment. This is a statewide database of OER curated by the students, librarians, instructors, and staff from the Florida colleges and universities. If teaching one of these courses, please review the curated list in SOAR for potential OER to adopt.

Google Advanced Search

Online search tools like [Google Advanced Search](#) may also help in searching for and locating OER for a course. The Google Advanced Search allows users to filter results by usage rights, but it does not offer a list of licenses to search by. Instead, Google gives its own descriptions of the licenses:

Then narrow your results
by...

language:	any language
region:	any region
last update:	anytime
site or domain:	not filtered by license
terms appearing:	free to use or share
file type:	free to use or share, even commercially
usage rights:	free to use share or modify
	free to use, share or modify, even commercially
	not filtered by license



Advanced Search

Be aware that search tools, like Google, rely on metadata being detected on the source webpage. It is wise to confirm the CC license on the content before reuse.

Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI)

In recent years, generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) has captured the attention of instructors in higher education. The upcoming Adapt and Author modules will address best practices for this technology in changing or creating OER. When adopting OER, GenAI may play a role in searching for materials. If you use GenAI (like ChatGPT) to find OER, make sure you verify the source of the content it provides as well as its accuracy and copyright status.

Instructor Voice

“[An open math homework and assessment platform] has a huge pool of questions I could choose from [and] provides a very detailed help if I want to author my own questions, which I take advantage of all the time. The ability to see my students’ work in real time via live polls, analyze past performance, and keep track of student progress is amazing.”

*Anna Lurie, Mathematics Department
Palm Beach State College*

Conclusion

Identifying search terms and compiling a list of potential OER using repositories and search tools is an active part of the OER adoption journey. During this stage, don’t take a deep dive into the resources. Pull together anything that may be relevant. The next chapter will discuss a more reflective step, evaluating the OER found.

Assessment

Which of these rubrics is preferable to use to evaluate OER: [OER Review Standards and Approval Rubric: United States Edition](#), [Achieve OER Rubrics](#), the [“Peralta Online Equity Rubric”](#), or another one not listed here? What makes this rubric preferable?

✓ Check





Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 5 Eva

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning o

--Understand perspectives on evaluating and defining 'quality' as it relates to cc

--Utilize relevant checklists/rubrics for evaluating Open Educational Resources

☐ Yes

☐ No

Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chap

--Understand perspectives on evaluating and defining 'quality' as it relates to cc

--Utilize relevant checklists/rubrics for evaluating Open Educational Resources

Submit

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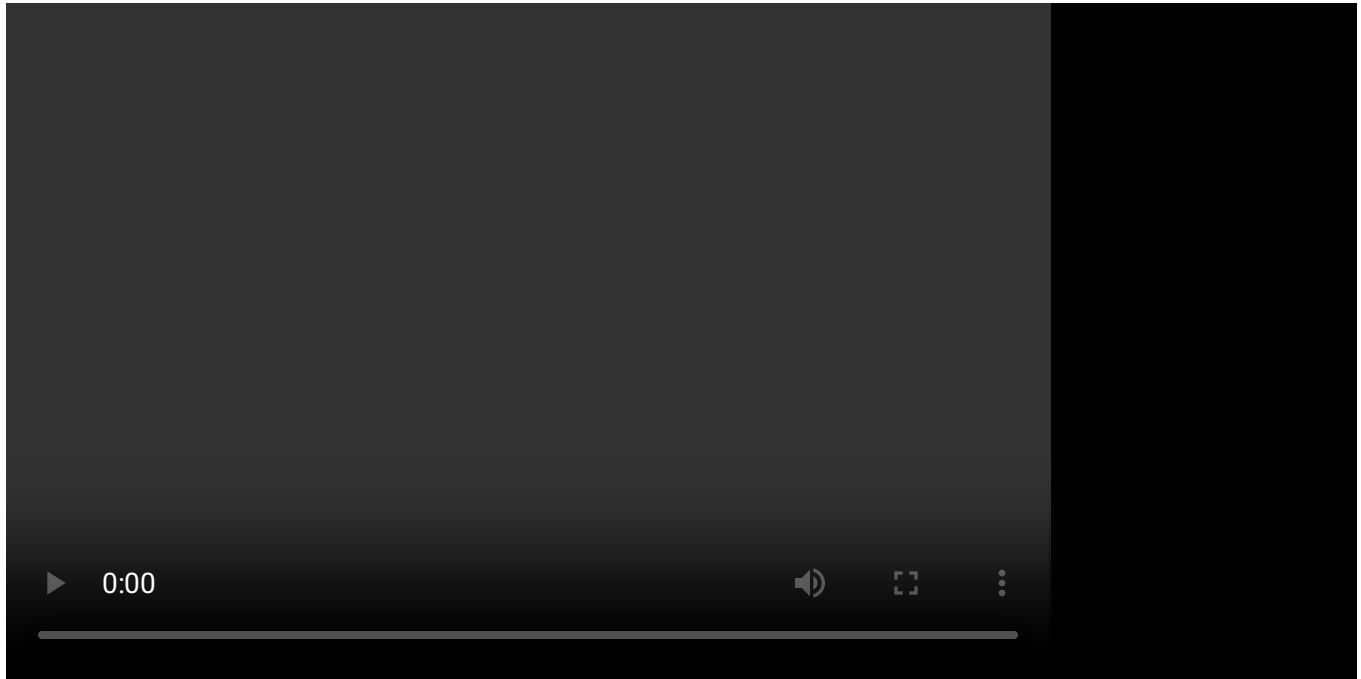
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2.3: Evaluating Open Educational Resources



“[How to Find and Evaluate OER](#)”

By Abbey Elder. Licensed under [CC BY 4.0](#). [Transcripts](#).

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to:

- Understand Perspectives on Evaluating and Defining “Quality” as it Relates to Course Materials
- Utilize Relevant Checklists/Rubrics for Evaluating Open Educational Resources

Introduction

The previous section focused on organizing a search and finding relevant Open Educational Resources (OER). This section will focus on evaluating OER and aligning these resources with course objectives. These skills help to narrow resources listed down to content that works best for instructors and their course. When evaluating OER, we encourage the reader to consider how they define and measure quality.

Learning Objective Check-In

When evaluating an OER resource, it is important that you check that the content matches your course learning objectives, true or false?

☐ True

☐ False

☒ Check

 Reuse

 Rights of use

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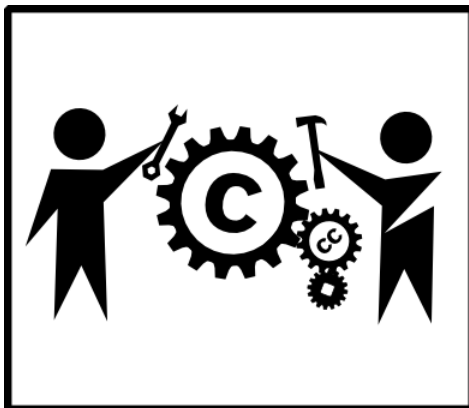
Evaluation

Suggestions for widely-adopted rubrics and checklists for evaluation include:

- [OER Review Standards and Approval Rubric: United States Edition](#)
(Developed with OPEN FL)
- [Achieve OER Rubrics](#)
- [Peralta Online Equity Rubric](#)
- [Affordable Learning Georgia \(PDF\)](#)

Please take a minute to review each one. Choose one that works best (see Appendix B in [OER Review Standards and Approval Rubric: United States Edition](#) for more options). If a department already uses a customized rubric for evaluating course material or textbooks for adoption, use that tool. Evaluating OER shouldn't be much different from evaluating other course material under consideration for adoption.

Rights and Permissions



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Using content without copyrights (public domain works), obtaining copyright permission (through written requests, CC or open licenses, or terms and agreements), or using works under a copyright exemption (Teach Act or Fair Use) are key components of the OER adoption process. Reviewing rights and permissions is a good first step in evaluating selected content. Instructors are advised to document the rights information for each content source and ensure that the planned use is permitted.

Content Validity

It's important to review the who, what, when, where, and why of OER content just as one would with any other source of information. This analysis should also include reading available reviews or ratings. Many OER have these publicly available (for example, the Open Textbook Library). Consider how effective the OER will be in meeting teaching and learning goals. Colleagues

may already be using this resource and be willing to give honest feedback on the OER. Ensure that the content is accurate and appropriate for higher education. Select content that has no obvious errors, conflicts of interest, or ethical concerns.

Accessibility (ADA and Beyond!)

The first step with accessibility is to confirm that students will have no barriers or restrictions to the content (apart from a student login to the learning management system provided by your institution). Next we check that educational content is available to all students at the same time. This means that any accommodations (navigable interface, structured layout, alt-text, closed captions, etc.) are already in place or can be made available before using the content in the course. Another key component to accessibility is language. Content should be available in the language needed for your learning environment. It should be written in a manner that is consistent, clear, and comprehensive to students. Instructors are encouraged to include opportunities to assess learning without a graded penalty before having students complete graded tasks. Because students have a variety of learning and assessment styles, allow options for completing activities in multiple formats where appropriate. When possible, provide print and multiple file format options to students, allowing them to learn in the medium of preference.



[recruiting for committees to improve accessibility](#) by [Province of British Columbia](#) under [CC BY-NC-ND 2.0](#)

[Province](#)

Supplementary Resources

OER that come with supplemental resources are instructor and student favorites and are more widely available each day. This content should also be reviewed for permissions, content validity, and accessibility. Please note that the OER and supplementary resources may be on different platforms. Other instructors who are using OER in the associated course may be an excellent source for finding and evaluating this type of content.

Cost and Impact

While OER is available as “free + permissions” there is a cost to implement OER in a course, which can vary depending on the content chosen and how it can be implemented into the environment. First determine the time it would take to adjust course content, resources, or structure to align with the OER. Then think about the number of resources that may be used from the department or institution. This calculation may include support time, tools or product purchases, and cost of hosting new services. Consider how long the OER will be sustainable for a course. These factors help determine the cost of implementation. Another important consideration is cost avoidance. Calculate this impact for a course by using this formula:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{[Existing or Comparable Commercial Textbook Cost: } _____\text{]} \\
 & \quad \times \\
 & \text{Average Student Enrollment Each Term/Semester: } _____\text{]} \\
 & \quad - \\
 & \text{Cost for Students, if any} \\
 & \text{(for example, required support/platforms/content): } _____\text{]}
 \end{aligned}$$

=
Total Cost Avoidance: _____

Instructor Voice

“Adopting Open Educational Resources promotes a favorable environment of accessibility, equity, and innovation in education, enriching learning experiences while breaking down barriers to knowledge for all.”

*Douglas Kines, Professor of Biological Sciences
Florida State College at Jacksonville*

Conclusion

Thoughtful evaluation of OER is the capstone of the search and retrieval process. Luckily, there are tools like checklists and rubrics to help appraise the OER found in order to make an informed choice for adoption. The next chapter will discuss the mechanics of incorporating selected OER into a course.

Assessment

Which repository listed above looks most appealing as a place to begin searching for OER?

✓ Check





Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 5 Eva

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning objectives:

--Understand perspectives on evaluating and defining 'quality' as it relates to content

--Utilize relevant checklists/rubrics for evaluating Open Educational Resources

☐ Yes

☐ No

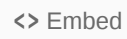
Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chapter's learning objectives:

--Understand perspectives on evaluating and defining 'quality' as it relates to content

--Utilize relevant checklists/rubrics for evaluating Open Educational Resources

Submit

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: How to Adopt Open Educational Resources

[3.1: Incorporating Open Educational Resources](#)

[3.2: Researching Open Educational Resources](#)

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3.1: Incorporating Open Educational Resources



[Open Educational Resources at Santa Fe College](#), Mar 17, 2017. [Transcript](#)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to:

- Identify How to Display Attribution
- Understand Options for Incorporating Open Content

Introduction

An advantage to using Open Educational Resource (OER) are legal rights to reuse and retain. After instructors find, evaluate, and decide to use OER in a class, they need to incorporate it. How and where students will access content is a key concern. Along with content permissions, format type(s), personal abilities, and support available. This will dictate how to incorporate content. Like, whether to embed OER or link out to it. While some open licenses do not allow adapting, one does not violate these licenses by:

- downloading/uploading as is
- embedding
- linking
- copying and pasting as is (no remix or combine)
- printing a self-copy

Learning Objective Check-In

Important aspects to consider when incorporating an open textbook into your course include (choose all that apply):

- ☐ The technical format of the original document.
- ☐ Your comfort level using technology.
- ☐ LMS' ability to hide the Creative Commons license because it's distracting.
- ☐ Accessibility of the content for students.

✓ Check

↻ Reuse

🔒 Rights of use

↔ Embed

H-P

Requirements for Attribution

It is ethical to give credit to all sources, even those within the Public Domain. All Creative Commons (CC) licensed materials require attribution with use. Best practice for CC attribution is to follow TASL:

- Title
- Author
- Source
- License

An [online Marking Guide](#) from CC demonstrates how to mark CC licenses on different media types. Attribution must be displayed with content when adopting OER. The viewer should easily find any attribution. Like, in course settings description, home page, and/or syllabus.

Drag the words into the correct boxes

CC attribution should include the Title, Author, Source, and License. Let's explain these elements in more detail:

- : What is the name of the work?
- : Who allows you to use the work?
- : Where can people find the work?
- : How can you use the work?

Source

Author

License

Title

✓ Check

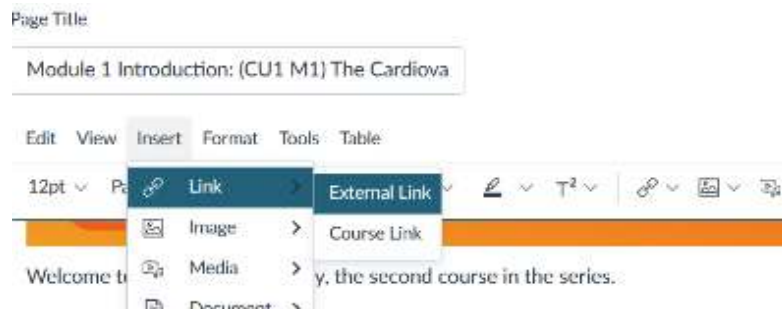
Example of a TASL attribution for this chapter:

Title, author, source, license =

[“Incorporating Open Educational Resources”](#) by [Florida Virtual Campus \(FLVC\) Library Services](#) in [LibreTexts for the Florida Virtual Campus: Supported by OPEN FL](#) under [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)

Linking Out

The saying, “when in doubt, link it out” has been echoed by many. Linking out to material has been seen as a “safer” way to use content. This is considered copyright-wise within a course since no copy is being created, only a link added. It may be one of the easiest ways to implement an OER in a course. So, it is presented here first.



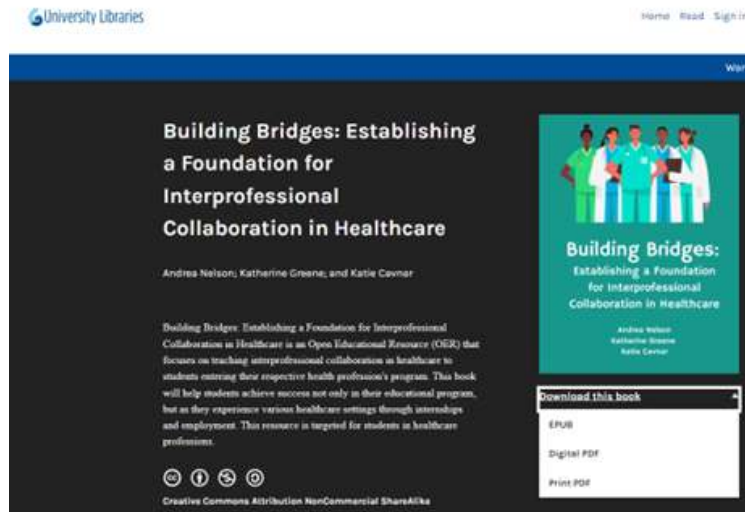
To create a link:

1. Log into your LMS (for example, Canvas) or site
2. Navigate to the course or section where you will be linking to outside content
3. Click to edit the content via the rich content editor
4. Place your cursor where you want the link to be
5. Click on Insert and then on Link (or the link symbol)
6. Paste the URL into the link's address field
7. Provide a descriptive title for the link in the Title field
8. Then click Done or Save

Go back into the page and click on the link to make sure it works. Make link review a regular part of course updates. As “link rot” can occur from term to term. Download and save any linked content. If it disappears from the internet mid-course, instructors may be able to continue to use the work that semester under given rights or a fair use exemption. If this happens, please document with the [Fair Use Evaluator](#).

Another reason to link out to an OER is to increase the download counts for the content. This improves the statistics data the OER author can present for Tenure and Promotion. It may also encourage the author to update the content to a new edition. Or they may write another OER for another course. Additionally, the author may make minor updates to the content without publishing a new edition. Linking to the content will ensure students are using the latest version of the content.

Downloading



To download:

1. Navigate to the OER site (for example, Pressbooks)
2. Search for your title
3. Then locate download options (drop-down menu, link, etc.). If multiple types are offered, select the file format(s) that best suits your needs
4. Download the resource file(s) to your computer or other device
5. Name the file and place it in a folder. File name should follow your organizing scheme and be easily identifiable to upload it to your course

We encourage instructors to use course packs; when available and appropriate for a course. If there is not a download option in a platform, contact the publisher. Ask if the publisher can provide a download or reach out to the author(s). Instructors may need to demonstrate that they are an instructor of record to access hidden content.

Uploading

Full Course Import

For Full Course Imports:

1. Log into the LMS (for example, Canvas) or site where you will upload the OER
2. Navigate to the specific course shell where you want to populate content
3. Find an “import course content” or similarly worded link and click on it
4. Select content type to upload/import
5. Click on Import
6. Then select the Course Export Package (available as file type in some OER repositories)
7. Click Done/Save



Navigate to modules and find the newly imported course content. Check each part for completeness. Note if any issues are reported from the upload. If needed, correct these within the imported course.

Importing Course Packs Guides by System:

- [Canvas Help](#)
- [Blackboard Help](#)
- [D2L Help](#)

Textbook or Single Resource Only

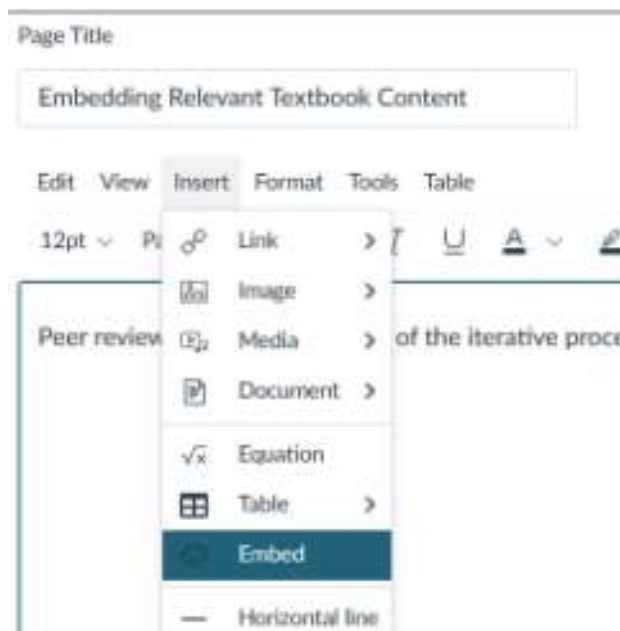


For Single Resource Load:

1. Log into the LMS or other site (for example, Google Drive) to which you will upload the OER
2. Navigate to the specific course
3. Find the folder where you will place the textbook
4. Click on the option to upload a file

There may be several options for ingesting content. For a complete textbook, instructors may be able to upload zipped files. Common cartridge files may be a better choice due to file size limits. If a common cartridge is not available, consider contacting the author of the resource—many authors are happy to share files with those using their content.

Embedding



If an embed code for the OER is not available, it may be possible to create one using an iframe. If needed, consult with LMS support or Instructional Design Team.

Embed a chapter or a full textbook within the rich content editor of your LMS:

1. Navigate to the course, module, and page in the LMS where you want to add a textbook or chapter
2. In the page's rich content editor, position the cursor where you want to embed the OER
3. Then click on Insert

4. Then Embed
5. Paste the embed code from the OER content site into the embed code field
6. Click Submit
7. Check that the chapter or textbook appear in the page

Another way to embed an OER textbook is using an Learning Tool Integration (LTI). In order to use this feature, contact local LMS support. Many LTIs cost extra and may not be part of an institutional package.

Copying and Pasting

7.

Quality

Questions about the quality of open educational resources has been cited as one of the top three concerns among faculty who are considering adopting OER, including open textbooks, to use in the classroom.^[1] Therefore, as an author of a textbook, it is vital to factor in the quality of your work during the planning stages.

Example of highlighted/copied text

Copy/Paste:

1. Log into your LMS (for example, Canvas)
2. Navigate to the course or place where you want to copy/paste content
3. Then, open the content from which you will copy/paste
4. Highlight text to copy by clicking and dragging your cursor over the text (shown in graphic)
5. Right click, and select copy. You can also press Ctrl + C [copy]
6. Return to the rich content editor or document where you want to paste the content
7. Click on the location where you want to insert the content
8. Right click, and select paste. You can also press Ctrl + V [paste] or Ctrl + Shift + V [paste without formatting].

Copying and pasting into the LMS may be useful. Especially when adopting smaller portions of the OER, such as one chapter. Please note if excerpts are combined with other material, this is considered a new version or derivative.

Print on Demand

Some instructors like to offer printable copies of the adopted OER for their students. Having options to order printed copies, through entities like Amazon and Lulu, is a service known as print on demand. Sites, like OpenStax and LibreTexts may offer these options on the OER record page. If print on demand isn't offered, instructors or students may create a printable document from formats offered. Library or OER staff may know additional options offered on campus, like institutional printing services.

Instructor Voice

"Using Open Educational Resources (OER) allows me to create engaging and relevant course content, leading to more personalized and meaningful learning experiences for students. This approach not only boosts student success but also reduces textbook costs and the burden they can entail. Over 18 semesters, my colleagues and I have saved over 5,000 students more than \$500,000."

Anne M. Prucha, Senior Instructor, Spanish & TESOL, University of Central Florida

Conclusion

Remember, OER and LMS platforms will vary in the steps required to implement. Ensure attribution of the OER is clear for students. For specific questions contact the technology or instructors support department.

Assessment

It is wrong to display a license and attribution for an adopted textbook more than once, true or false?

☐ True☐ False☒ Check



Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 6 Incorporating

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning objectives:

--Identify how to display attribution

--Understand options for incorporating open content

☐ Yes

☐ No

Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chapter's learning objectives:

--Identify how to display attribution

--Understand options for incorporating open content

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3.2: Researching Open Educational Resources



[What does the research say about OER?](#)

By: [The Council of Chief State School Officers](#), Video: [CC BY 4.0](#), Music: [Lahaina by Blue Dot Sessions](#): [CC BY NC 4.0](#). [Transcript](#)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, one will be able to :

- Understand areas of research in Open Educational Resources
- Identify ways to research Open Educational Resources adoption

Introduction

An important part of learning about open educational resources (OER) is understanding the research being done in this arena of open content. Baseline research has shown that OER “do no harm,” meaning they are of good quality and serve students as well as or better than traditionally published materials (Jhangiani et al., 2018). Further studies have shown that instructors’ knowledge about and use of OER is increasing; students benefit from courses using OER, and the quality of this material is considered to be good. The Cost/Outcomes/Use/Perceptions (COUP) framework is a useful model to follow for those wanting to do their own research into the effectiveness of OER.

Learning Objective Check-in

Research shows that faculty awareness and use of open educational resources (OER) has increased.

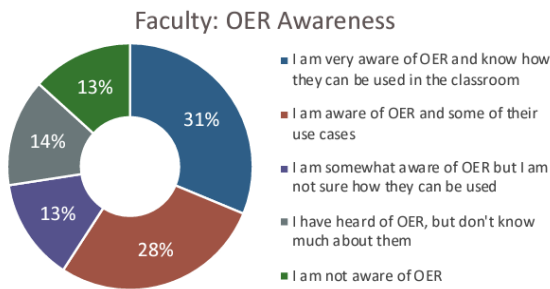
☐ True

☐ False

☒ Check

Awareness and Perception

Research shows that instructors’ knowledge about and use of OER is increasing. According to a 2023 study by Bay View Analytics, 85% of instructors had some type of awareness of OER. Beyond awareness, “1 in 2 instructors used OER materials, and about 1 in 3 instructors required an OER material in at least one course.” Survey leads did not identify a singular factor in the rising levels of awareness or usage, but a mix of factors. This mix includes OER offering more affordable course materials and professors becoming more familiar and comfortable with searching for and using online resources (Coffey, 2023). An additional study of over 450 instructors “found that autonomous motivation (engagement with OER textbooks based on enjoyment, value) was the strongest positive predictor of current and future OER textbook use” (Herbert et al., 2023).



Faculty: OER Awareness by [Julia E. Seaman, PhD, and Jeff Seaman, PhD](#)

([Bay View Analytics](#)) under [CC BY 4.0](#)

How to Raise Awareness

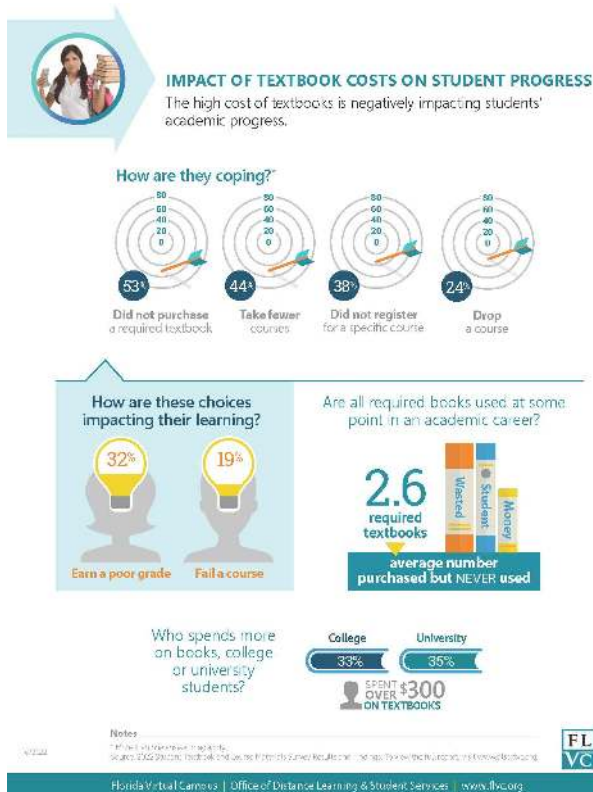
- Share knowledge with department colleagues
- Write about personal experience
- Present to discipline at conferences or events
- Provide a review for an OER

Student Impact

Research on OER shows its beneficial impact on students. A large-scale study showed that OER adoption helped student success metrics: grades improved and drop/fail/withdrawal rates decreased, with heightened results in these areas for Pell grant recipients (Colvard et al, 2018). Textbook affordability efforts encourage students to “sell textbooks back at the end of each term,” but students reported selling books before finals indicating students may instead be trying to “get the best buyback price” (FLDOE, 2018). With zero-cost OER, we eliminate textbook cost coping measures, and potential risks.

The FLVC Textbook Survey consistently reports how textbook costs hamper students’ academic gains. It makes sense that eliminating or reducing this cost burden should positively increase their academic progress.

- [2022 Student Textbook Survey – Infographic \(PDF\)](#)
- [2022 Student Textbook and Course Materials Survey and Information Executive Summary \(PDF\)](#)
- [2022 Student Textbook and Instructional Material Survey- Results and Findings](#)



2022 Textbook Survey Infographic by [Florida Virtual Campus \(FLVC\)](#)

[Distance Learning and Student Services](#)

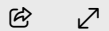
A [2023 survey](#) conducted by Affordable Learning PA and others echoes the FLVC Student Textbook Survey Findings. Over fifty percent of students surveyed says they take fewer courses or don't register for a specific course because of course materials costs. Other impacts, such as earning a poor grade or dropping a course, were reported by significant percentages of students as well (Mowreader, 2024).

Zero Textbook Cost Data

Statewide Florida Shines ZTC Data Dashboard:

Microsoft Power BI

< 1 of 5 >



Use and Quality

How to Research Implementation

Many questions about the impacts of OER adoption can be addressed through the [COUP Framework](#). This framework focuses on the issues of:

- Cost
 - Research Question: How much money was saved by this OER adoption?
 - The amount saved is the difference between the cost of the previous textbook and the cost of the OER.
- Outcomes
 - Research Question: How do students' final grades differ when instructors assign OER instead of commercial textbooks?
 - Research Question: How do Course Throughput Rates change when instructors assign OER instead of commercial textbooks or digital content as the required materials for a course?
(The Course Throughput Rate or CTR, combines the effect of drop rates, withdraw rates, and final grades to show the percentage of students present on the first day of class who complete the course with a final grade of C or better.)
 - Research Question: How do students' enrollment intensity (number of credits taken) and semester-to-semester persistence change when instructors assign OER instead of commercial textbooks or digital content as the required materials for a course?
- Use
 - Research Question: How does student use of resources differ between traditional learning resources and OER?
 - Research Question: To what extent (if any) are instructors and students utilizing the legal permissions facilitated by OER?
- Perceptions
 - Research Question: How do students perceive the quality of the OER?
 - Research Question: How do instructors perceive the quality of the OER?

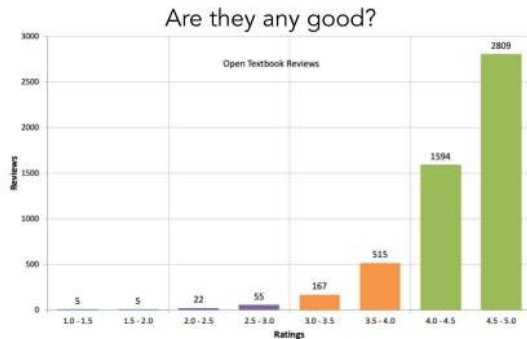
There are many additional resources for learning more about OER research. Please visit the [Guidebook to Research on Open Educational Resources Adoption](#) for information regarding OER research tools such as:

- Data collection templates
- Data definitions
- Sample student surveys

- Sample instructor surveys
- Links to completed sample studies
- Resources for completing Institutional Review Board protocols

Research on Quality

The Open Education Network (OEN) reports that instructor reviews of OER collected in their Open Textbook Library are consistently high. Eighty-two percent of the reviews rated the textbooks in the top two quality categories (4 to 4.5 and 4.5 to 5.0)



Education Network (OEN), under [CC BY 4.0](#)

[Intro to OER Adoption Workshop Are they any Good Slide](#) (2024) by [Open](#)

Leader Voice

“OER degree pathway implementation can contribute to transformational institutional change...At many of colleges, adoption of OER is spreading beyond clear issues of student affordability to the less obvious issues of access, completion, reducing time to degree, decreasing debt, advancing equity, and rethinking pedagogy, setting into motion policy, funding and systems change at the institutional, state and federal level.”

*Dr. Karen A. Stout, President & CEO
Achieving the Dream*

Conclusion

This chapter introduced areas of OER research. Using the COUP framework instructors can research their OER implementation. Sharing the results of OER implementation can continue to raise awareness and provide great research to include in tenure and promotion portfolios.

Assessment

Ways to raise awareness about OER among faculty include:

- ☐ Present to discipline at conferences or events
- ☐ Share knowledge with department colleagues
- ☐ Write about personal experience
- ☐ All of these answers are correct.

✓ Check



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Adopting OER: Survey for Chapter 7 Researching

Completing this chapter enables the learner to perform the following learning objectives:

--Understand areas of research in Open Educational Resources

--Identify ways to research Open Educational Resources adoption

☐ Yes

☐ No

Please provide feedback regarding learning and being able to perform this chapter's learning

--Understand areas of research in Open Educational Resources

--Identify ways to research Open Educational Resources adoption

Submit

4: Assessment and Certificate of Completion



Congratulations for reading and completing the Adopt Open Educational Resources modules!

You now have the opportunity to take a [final assessment](#) (link takes you to a LibWizard site).

Instructions for completing the assessment and requesting a certificate of completion are included in the assessment.

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5: Attributions

1.1 Introduction to Open Educational Resources

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Fischer, L., Hilton, J., Robinson, T.J. et al. A multi-institutional study of the impact of open textbook adoption on the learning outcomes of post-secondary students. *J Comput High Educ* 27, 159–172 (2015). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12528-015-9101-x>

Colvard, N., Watson, C., Park, H. (2018). [The impact of open educational resources on various student success metrics](#). *International Journal of Teaching and Learning in Higher Education*, 30 (2).

[2024 Florida Statutes Chapter 1006.73 Florida Postsecondary Academic Library Network \(4\) \(a\)](#) by the State of Florida in the public domain

1.2 Understanding Open Educational Resources

[Spectrum of Open](#) by OPEN FL & Rebel Cummings-Sauls, OPEN FL Libguide, Florida Virtual Campus

[Florida Statutes 2023](#) in the public domain

[“What are the Qualifications for a Course to have Florida’s ZTC Indicator?”](#) by [FLVC Distance Learning & Student Services](#)

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3.2 Researching Open Educational Resources

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Instructor Perspectives



Confessions from OER Adopters Implementing Open Education Resources from the Faculty Perspective, Mar 4, 2024

Description: Join Department of Anthropology faculty as they discuss 3 different methods for implementing open education resources in the classroom. From adaption to adoption to creation, listen to real-world experiences and learn more about the time involved, benefits to you, students, and department, and how to get started.

Start at 42:58-47:38



OER Faculty Interviews 2020/2021. BY Cal Poly Humboldt University Library, Sep 15, 2021

Description: OER has an impact on student learning. The Humboldt State University Affordable Learning Solutions (AL\$) team at the Library interviewed several faculty about using OER in their courses. Here's what they had to share about the impact using OER has had on their students.

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